Initial research into organizations that are willing to fund a grant shows that this is an active area of interest. It's an excellent time for us to be stepping into this opportunity. As of **2026**, the federal focus has shifted from "Can we build it?" to "**Can we trust it?**" There are several high-value funding streams currently active that align perfectly with a **Universal Trust Measurement (UTM) engine**.

1. NIH: Bridge2AI Stage II

The NIH Common Fund's **Bridge2AI** program recently entered **Stage II (approved Jan 2026)**. While Stage I focused on data generation, Stage II is specifically designed to deliver **trusted solutions**.

- **The Opportunity:** They are building a "Network for AI Health Science" to develop safety measures and responsible AI frameworks.
- **The Fit:** A universal trust engine could serve as the "Integration, Dissemination, and Evaluation" (BRIDGE) layer they need to validate models before clinical deployment.
- **Key Focus:** Ethical sourcing, reliability, and "AI-ready" validation.

2. DARPA: AIQ (Artificial Intelligence Quantified)

This is arguably the most direct match for a "Trust Measurement engine." The **AIQ program** (managed under the Information Innovation Office) seeks to develop technology to assess and understand AI capabilities to enable **guaranteed performance**.

- **The Goal:** Moving away from "vibes-based" trust toward mathematical foundations and quantified measurement.
- **The Fit:** Your concept of a "Risk Profiling Model" for AI is exactly what DARPA is looking for to ensure warfighters can "appropriately trust" their machine partners.
- **On-Prem/Cloud:** DARPA frequently prioritizes solutions that can operate in disconnected or secure (on-prem) environments for national security.

3. NSF: NAIRR and SaTC 2.0

The **National Artificial Intelligence Research Resource (NAIRR)** is now in full swing as of early 2026.

- **NAIRR-OC (Operations Center):** A primary goal of the $35 million solicitation (NSF 25-546) is to "advance AI interpretability, security, and trust."
- **SaTC 2.0 (Security, Privacy, and Trust in Cyberspace):** This is the recurring bread-and-butter for trust-related funding. They are looking for "universal" frameworks that can be applied across domains, from cloud services to critical infrastructure.

4. NIST: Center for AI Standards and Innovation (CAISI)

In February 2026, NIST's **CAISI** announced a new **AI Agent Standards Initiative**.

- **SBIR Phase I & II:** NIST has been actively awarding millions (most recently in Feb 2026) to small businesses developing AI measurement and validation tools.
- **The Fit:** The **SBIR (Small Business Innovation Research)** route is your best bet for turning a "Measurement engine" into a commercialized service. NIST is specifically interested in tools that can stress-test agentic AI and GenAI.

5. ARPA-H: ADVOCATE Program

Launched in January 2026, the **ADVOCATE** program (Agentic AI-EnableD CardioVascular CAre TransfOrmation) is looking for **"Supervisory Agents."**

- **The "Engine":** They need a system to monitor and ensure the safety/accuracy of patient-facing AI agents. This is essentially an "on-prem/cloud trust assessment service" for the medical domain.

Comparison of Funding Targets

Agency	Program	Primary Focus	Suitability for "Universal" Engine
DARPA	AIQ	Mathematical Guarantees	**High** (Foundational/Universal)
NIH	Bridge2AI (Stage II)	Health Trust Networks	**Medium** (Domain-Specific)
NIST	CAISI / SBIR	Standards & Measurement	**High** (Commercialization Focus)
NSF	SaTC 2.0	General Cyber Trust	**Medium** (Research/Academic Focus)
ARPA-H	ADVOCATE	Agent Supervision	**Medium** (Agentic AI focus)

Recommended Strategy

Since our UTM Engine heavily relies on mathematical modeling or formal methods, **DARPA's AIQ** is the gold standard for funding that type of "revolutionary" leap.